Prof. Irwin Cotler, a prominent legal expert from McGill University in Montreal and a former Canadian member of parliament and justice minister, has discussed the anti-Semitic aspect of fundamentalist Islam, emphasizing that the extent of Islamic hatred for Judaism and Jews has reached the dimension of calls for genocide. He has proposed replacing the word *anti-Semitism* in this context, as there is an internal contradiction in the definition of Muslim hatred of Judaism as anti-Semitism, and the intensity of the detestation requires a new definition of the phenomenon.

It is customary to mark September 11, 2001, as the point in time when fundamentalist Islam's global ambitions made their debut, although their flag bearers at the time, Osama bin Laden and al-Qaeda, had been around for several years prior to this historic date. The first question that comes to mind when we think of the heinous attack on the World Trade Center in New York and the Pentagon in Washington, D.C., concerns the root of the hatred that could bring people— some of them graduates of universities in the United States and western Europe—to commit such acts. I recommend searching for the answer to this question in the explanations of Bernard Lewis, a professor emeritus at Princeton University, who was considered the greatest historian of his generation on the Muslim world. Lewis, a London-born Jew, was known as the "doyen of the Orientalists."

Exploring the "roots of Muslim rage"—the name of an article he published several years ago—Lewis stated that the entire Muslim world today is experiencing a sense of frustration and crisis. Everything has gone wrong. For more than a thousand years, Muslims were accustomed to the notion that they were the most advanced people in the world and that they had set the gold standard in politics, economics, and science. With the new age, the Muslims realized that their power had faded and that even the adoption of Western technology could not revive it. The imported Western ideas of socialism and capitalism did not stem the economic and cultural decline of the Islamic world. Then came the thought that salvation perhaps lay in the adoption of the model of the Western democratic regime. Unfortunately, the only Western model that succeeded in taking root in the Muslim world was that of the one-party dictatorship. The political independence won by Arab and Muslim states during the twentieth century did not give rise to freedom.

The reaction to these disappointments was opposition to all ideas imported from the West, and the blaming of the West for all of the evils